

[REDACTED]

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**Justification Review Document
For Sole Source - FAR 13.501**

Program/Equipment: The U.S. Army Office of the Chief of Public Affairs (OCPA) has a requirement for Communication and Planning Support Services.

Authority: Simplified Procedures for Certain Commercial Items, 41 U.S.C. as implemented by FAR Subpart 13.5.

Amount: \$819,615.66

Prepared by:

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]
Date: 16 April 2025

Contracting Officer:

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]
Date: 16 April 2025

Technical:

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]
Date: 16 April 2025

Requirements:

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]
Date: 16 April 2025

Reviews: I have reviewed this justification and find it adequate to support sole source.

Program Manager / Deputy, Strategy and Plans Division:

[REDACTED]

COM: [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

Date: See digital signature

Small Business Professional:

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

Date: See digital signature

[Redacted]

MICC Legal Counsel:

[Redacted]

[Redacted]

Date: See digital signature

Director, MICC-Fort Sam Houston:

[Redacted]

[Redacted]

Date: See digital signature

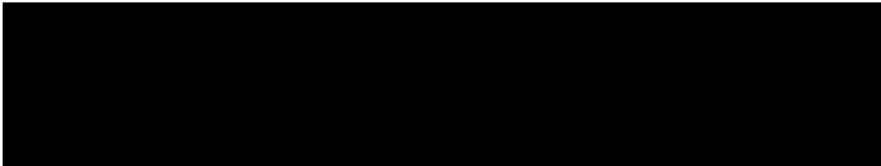
Assistant Director, Small Business Program:

[Redacted]

[Redacted]

Date: See digital signature

[Redacted]



FAR 13.5 Sole Source Justification and Approval

1. Contracting Activity: U.S. Army Mission and Installation Contracting Command - Fort Sam Houston (MICC-FSH), 2205 Infantry Post Road, Joint Base San Antonio - Fort Sam Houston, TX

2. Description of Action: The Office of the Chief of Public Affairs (OCA) requests a Firm-Fixed Price (FFP) modification to bridge contract W9124J25C0004 with Crux DCG to provide continued services for Communication and Planning Support Services. This contract is set to expire on 3 May 2025 and the Government projects award of the modification by 2 May 2025 to extend for an additional 4-month period which will include a 30 day phase out period. Fiscal Year 2025 Operations and Maintenance funds will be used. An acquisition plan is not required because this procurement does not meet the threshold at Defense Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement 207.103(d)(i)(B).

3. Description of Supplies/Services: This is a non-personal services contract to provide Business Rules and OCA Operations Support, Communication Research, Analysis and Evaluation, Communication Planning, Communication Product Development, Army Outreach Support, Professional Development and Training, Exhibit Management, and Executive Communication Support. The work to be performed under this contract will be performed at the Office of the Chief of Public Affairs, 1500 Army Pentagon, Washington DC 20310.

Period of Performance: 4 MAY 2025 – 3 SEP 2025 Value: \$819,615.66

4. Authority Cited: Simplified Procedures for Certain Commercial Items, 41 U.S.C. 1901 as implemented by FAR Subpart 13.5: Unusual and compelling urgency.

5. Reason for Authority Cited:

a. Bridge contract W9124J25C0004 was awarded 23 December 2024 and is set to expire on 3 May 2025. This bridge was put in place to allow for additional procurement time and a 30-day phase-in for the follow-on contract. Contract W9124J25C0007 was subsequently awarded on 27 March 2025 for a total period of performance of 5 years. On 9 April 2025, the contracting office was notified by counsel that one of the unsuccessful offerors had filed a Government Accountability Office (GAO) protest (B-423450) regarding the contract award of W9124J25C0007 and a Competition in Contracting Act stay/stop work order was required immediately. The GAO has up to 100 days from the date a protest is filed to render a decision. This 120-day extension to the existing bridge contract will allow adequate time for the GAO process and final decision. In the meantime, continued support of these services is critical to the Army, as it provides communication and planning support to keep important and diverse internal audiences (U.S. Army) and external audiences (the public) informed, which helps to establish the conditions that lead to confidence in America's Army. Crux DCG, a certified VOSB and the incumbent, can continue to provide these services. Crux DCG has performed these services in a satisfactory manner for OCA since 4 January 2022

[REDACTED]

and is able to meet the unchanged requirements of the performance work statement (PWS).

b. Alternatives. OCPA could perform some of the critical work for four months without this contractor support, while temporarily suspending all non-critical functions until a new contract is in place. This approach carries risks related to workload and potential delays in both critical and non-critical areas, but represents a possible path forward in the absence of other options.

c. Impact if this Justification is not approved. OCPA would experience a break in service, creating major impacts to the communication research, analysis, evaluation and planning support provided by this contract. The quantitative and qualitative media analysis would hinder the timeliness of OCPA's communication efforts and messaging. A lapse in services would also affect management of the Meet Your Army (MYA) Army Senior Leader speaker's program. The program would lack targeting and engagement efforts in support of the program and Army Senior Leadership participation.

6. Efforts to Obtain Competition: In accordance with FAR 5.202(a)(2), this action will not be synopsisized. Because this is a sole source action, effective competition is not applicable. As a result of a GAO protest received on 9 April 2025, a stop work order was issued against the recent competitively awarded contract W9124J25C0007. To avoid a break in service during the protest resolution process, a sole-source modification to the bridge contract for 120 days is being awarded to Crux DCG based on urgent and compelling need IAW FAR 13.501. Crux DCG is the only viable option for the bridge contract and was deemed capable of performing the services due to their current support provided on the existing contracts.

7. Actions to Increase Competition: A final award is pending the outcome of a GAO protest filed on 8 April 2025. GAO is afforded up to 100 days to render a final decision.

8. Market Research:

a. In accordance with DFARS 213.501(a)(i) and DFARS PGI 206.303-2(b)(i)(A), a sources sought notice (SSN) was posted on SAM.gov and GSA concurrently on 20 September 2024 for the competitive follow-on requirement. The result of this SSN is within a 12-month timeframe and provides sufficient information to meet the needs of the DFARS requirement. Sixty capabilities statements were received from various small business contractors in response to the posted Sources Sought Notice. Several small businesses were found capable of providing this requirement.

Capabilities Statements Technical Review

No	Potential Offeror	Capable?	Comments
1	[REDACTED]	NO	Capabilities as stated don't fit the scope of work requested.

No	Potential Offeror	Capable?	Comments
2		NO	Capabilities undetermined based on interest email submitted by the vendor.
3		YES	Provided an adequate overview on required contract support; not a lot of detail on research and assessments experience.
4		YES	Extensive write-up and experience for dashboard solutions; not much information on their research, planning and assessments experience
5		YES	Most of experience dealt with event planning and leader development programs; not a lot of public affairs experience. Did mention their experience with developing and managing dashboards for the organizations they supported. Much of what they said they can do is very generic.
6		YES	Very broad description on experience aligned with the PWS; not a lot of public affairs experience to include research, planning and assessments; good writeup for producing media products but that's not the bulk of this contract
7		NO	Capabilities as stated don't fit the scope of work requested.
8		NO	not certified HUZone on SBA website; not enough detail to determine if their experience and capabilities are aligned with the requirements of the PWS.
9		NO	not certified 8(a) on SBA website; contractor has experience with dashboards but other than that, capabilities as stated don't fit the scope of the work requested.
10		NO	Capabilities as stated don't fit the scope of work requested. No details describing strategic communication experience.
11		YES	Extensive experience with dashboards and service with [REDACTED] which could benefit OCPA; experience with campaigns and producing content aligns with PWS deliverables.
12		YES	Contractor hit upon PWS requirements and seems to have experience in all the areas or would subcontract with a partner for some of that work. The contractor also brings up a good point in the recommendations block - probably not a question for OCPA to answer but we can certainly provide context based off current performance.
13		YES	Not certified SDVOSB on SBA website, [REDACTED] may be. Good overview of current support they are providing but there seems to be some inflation of what they are currently providing. As an example, their team supported Medal of Honor activities but the bulk of that work was executed by the graphic designer - they didn't execute all the tasks identified. Same goes for Content Creation.
14		YES	With the exception of dashboard solutions, the contractor recited back elements from the PWS but didn't elaborate on their experience in managing these areas.

No	Potential Offeror	Capable?	Comments
15		YES	Meets several MICC SB goals; describes experience with some of the PWS requirements but capabilities seem outside of a strategic communication scope.
16		NO	is the UEI on the SBA website; capabilities as stated don't fit the scope of the work requested. Much of experience deals with delivering IT solutions.
17		YES	Core competencies are not aligned with requirements in the PWS. Past performance references some of the areas we've identified in the PWS but little to no details.
18		YES	Meets several MICC SB goals; seems to have some overlap identifying capabilities that are needed to execute the PWS deliverables but recent experience is more marketing vs. strategic communication.
19		YES	Experience with multiple DOD clients which could be a benefit to OCPA; provided good examples of past experience applicable to the PWS requirements.

Although market research indicates other potential vendors, no other vendor can provide the services needed within this critical window between now and the end of the current contract 3 May 2025. The incumbent contractor is currently working communication plans and providing support services needed during this transition period.

9. Interested Sources: See Paragraph 6 and 8 for the synopsis information. To date, no other sources have expressed interest in this short-term bridge acquisition.

10. Other Facts: This is not a new requirement. Historical procurement data is shown below:

Procurement History:

- 1) Contract No: W9124J25C0007
Contractor: CruxDCG, LLC (CAGE 8NU77)
Period of Performance: 4 April 2025 – 9 April 2025
Amount: \$12,818,454.08
Competitive Status: SDVOSB Competitive Set-Aside
- 2) Contract No: W9124J22C0004
Contractor: CruxDCG, LLC (CAGE 8NU77)
Period of Performance: 4 January 2022 – 3 January 2025
Amount: \$7,484,910.01
Competitive Status: SDVOSB Competitive Set-Aside

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- 3) Contract No: W15QKN18C0025
Contractor: District Comm Group LLC (CAGE 65T66)
Period of Performance: 23 March 2018 – 2 July 2021
Amount: \$7,074,735.72
Competitive Status: Competitive Small Business Set-Aside
- 4) Contract No: W15QKN15C0110
Contractor: Metro Productions Government Svcs, LLC (CAGE 4UP65)
Period of Performance: 24 September 2015 – 13 July 2018
Amount: \$4,842,514.07
Competitive Status: Competitive Small Business Set-Aside

Date: 2025.04.29 11:30:09 -04'00'

Contracting Officer Representative

Date: 2025.04.29 13:07:55 -04'00'

Program Manager/Deputy Strategy and Plans Director

Date: 2025.04.29 20:44:50 -05'00

Contracting Officer

Date: 2025.04.29 20:45:15 -05'00'

Contracting Officer

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

Approval

Based on the foregoing justification, I hereby approve the procurement of Communication and Planning Support Services on a sole source basis pursuant to the authority of the Simplified Procedures for Certain Commercial Items, 41 U.S.C. 1901 as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 13.5. The estimated value of the modification is \$819,615.66 for a 4-month period of performance from 4 May 2025 through 3 September 2025. The approval is subject to availability of funds, and provided that the services or supplies herein described have otherwise been authorized for acquisition.

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

Date: 2025.05.06 10:08:27
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[REDACTED]

Alternate Advocate for Competition
U.S. Army Mission and Installation Contracting Command
JBSA Fort Sam Houston, TX